

VISVESSWAR A M - COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING DEPARTMENT

Technology Development Program Associate at Optum

About the Company:

Optum, part of the UnitedHealth Group family of businesses, is a leading information and technology-enabled health services company, serving more than 132 million consumers and delivering the right care when and how it's needed. Optum is dedicated in evolving healthcare so everyone can have the opportunity to live their healthiest life.

About the Role:

The Technology Development Program (TDP) at Optum is an entry point into the world of health technology, providing recent graduates the opportunity to gain hands-on experience in developing, implementing, and supporting advanced technological solutions that improve healthcare services. As a Software Engineering Associate within TDP, you'll contribute to projects across multiple domains, including artificial intelligence, data analytics, and application development, all while supporting the modernization of healthcare.

Overview of the Process:

The selection process consisted of three stages:

1. **Online Test** - Involved completing **4 tiers of tasks** in **Web Development** with Tech Stack of our choice from the provided options. An **AI-Chat assistant** was also provided which we could make use of when needed.
2. **HR Interview**- A brief interview involving questions based on personal experiences and interest in Optum.
3. **Technical Interview** - Technical skills and project experience mentioned in the Resume were discussed in depth and also included a few Behavioural questions.

About 27 students were shortlisted for the In-person Interview process held in CUIC.

HR Interview:

She Introduced herself.

Started with info about my nativity and experience so far in clg life.

Asked about extra curriculums in addition to academic.

Explained my interest in chess.

Asked any achievements in chess and asked why not continue it , or take it more seriously to which I answered that I focused more on academics.

Following it she Asked how I would manage multiple tasks when such a situation arises.

Asked about happy and sad memories across the years spent in college.

Since I mentioned about being part of club, I was asked about overview of activities in the club, about the interactions with juniors

Why did you choose Computer Science in High school and why CSE in CEG, why not IT?

Ended with questions from my side.

Technical Interview:

It started with self introduction.

Followed by questions on Java basics and OOPS .

Difference between **class**, **abstract class**, and **interface**.

Explain **polymorphism** and how run time polymorphism works.

Then the topic shifted to **React.js**

I was asked about virtual DOM, Single Page Application (SPA).

Why use react and not html+js for dynamic web page?

What happens when we **build a project**? What does the **build folder** contain?

How many **HTML files** are there **in react**, how does this html file work in react (it's role - **root div**)?

He also asked about the **need of backend** when we can access databases directly from frontend.

Then he asked about **APIs**, how it works,

Followed by what is **RESTApi**? After answering these questions, he gave me an DSA question.

The question was to find **second largest element** in an array. I was asked to write down my code in java since I picked it earlier as my goto language.

After traversing the input array for my code, he pointed out incorrect logic for some case, and after corrections I completed the optimal code and he was happy to move on.

Asked about the different **joins** and then about the **foreign key constraints**.

He asked whether I had knowledge about **cloud services** like AWS, azure etc...

Explain - **SAAS, PAAS, IAAS**.

At the end he asked me some **behavioural questions** -

Your strongest tech skill,

How did you manage a situation of difficulty when working in team?,

How do you learn new technologies ?,

How will you adapt to latest technologies?,

Why Optum?,

Asked me if I had any questions to him.

The interview ended with few questions from my side, the interviewer took time to explain the questions even as the lunch time had passed.

Result:

A total of 9 students were selected for the TDP Associate role at Optum.

Tips:

- Start the preparations early and focus on preparing for both **DSA** as well as Core subjects (**DBMS, OS, Computer Networks**).
- I followed [strivers-sde-sheet](#) for the preparation. You can also make use of the resources provided by **ACM CODE**.
- Focus on understanding the concepts and **practise** pattern-specific questions on online coding platforms like Leetcode, GFG or any other platform of your choice.
- Be **consistent** in the preparation journey.
- Do research about the company prior to the interviews and prepare questions to ask the interviewer.
- Be honest in your Resume and have a good and deep understanding on mentioned technical skills.
- Be confident with the answers and answer 'No' when questioned on unknown topics.

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